

Managing Your IT Infrastructure with Zentyal

Zentyal (formerly eBox Platform) is a program for servers used in small and medium enterprises (SMBs). It plays multiple roles—as a gateway, network infrastructure manager, unified threat manager, office server, unified communications server or a combination of all of the above. This is the second article in our series on Zentyal.



In the previous article, we discussed the installation of Zentyal in two scenarios. In this article, let's consider DHCP, DNS and a captive portal set-up.

Zentyal installation creates default settings that are not suitable for a production environment. Here, we will look at how to overrun those settings and create custom settings. I will start with DNS, then discuss the steps to be taken for DHCP, followed by a captive portal.

The DNS set-up

In my previous article, we had set up a domain name, which we will now use for setting up our DNS. The steps for configuration are as follows:

1. Open the Zentyal dashboard by using the IP address configured.
2. The URL will be <https://your-ip-address>.
3. Enter the user ID and password.
4. In the dashboard, you will see different categories like *Core*, *Infrastructure*, *Office*, etc. Click 'DNS' under 'Infrastructure'.
5. Select 'Enable transparent DNS cache'. With this setting, DNS will cache all the DNS requests, which will be routed through an internal DNS server. The clients have to use Zentyal as their gateway. Also enable the 'Firewall' module by traversing to 'Module Status' under the *Core* section. Click the 'Save changes' button on the top left of the screen to save the settings and enable the service.
6. The next option is 'DNS forwarder'. With this option, all the DNS requests that come to the server will first be searched in local cache. If not found, they will be forwarded to external forwarders. Select 'Add New' and give your router address, and ISP-supplied gateway. VirtualBox users need to enter their DHCP gateway address. Click the 'Save changes' button on the top left of